

BarberTemp

EARN . LIVE . THRIVE | The labour exchange platform for the barbering industry

Introduction for Haatch | Submitted via introduction from Graham Byrne | Prepared by John Webb O'Rourke, Commercial Lead | July 2026 | Confidential

DRAFT FOR REVIEW -- Johnny Shanahan | Not for circulation until approved

The Problem

The UK barbering industry is worth over £1 billion a year, and it runs on a structural inefficiency nobody has solved. Every barbershop is two barbers away from serious trouble: a holiday, a sick day, or a barber simply taking a day off means empty chairs and lost revenue that cannot be recovered. On the other side, most barbers today are self-employed and have days they want to work with no guaranteed place to go. The shop has an empty chair. A skilled barber wants to fill it. No platform connects them in real time.

The Solution

BarberTemp is the labour exchange for the barbering industry. Barbers post their available days, tier and day rate. Shops post open chairs. The platform matches them in minutes; both sides confirm, the barber shows up, the work gets done, payment goes through the app, and both sides rate the experience. Emergency cover carries a surge premium: the shop keeps revenue it would have lost, and the barber earns more when needed most.

Barbers are matched by a four-tier skill system (Barber, Barber Pro, Super Pro, Super Pro Hair) so every shop gets the right skill and every barber earns at the correct rate. The platform is AI-native: intelligent matching, demand prediction and platform intelligence are designed in from the ground up, so the system gets smarter with every booking and builds a proprietary data layer that a copied app would not have.

Market and Validation

UK-first, London proof of concept. The UK market exceeds £1 billion annually. In summer 2026 OpenChair launched publicly in the United States, an app allowing barbers and stylists to find and rent chairs nationwide, confirming demand for real-time chair-and-barber matching. No equivalent labour exchange platform exists in the UK. The first-mover window is open now.

Business Model -- Five Revenue Streams

Stream	Description	Timing
Commission	Percentage of every booking, payable by the shop	Day 1
Membership	Monthly subscriptions for barbers and shops; enhanced features, priority matching	Month 3
In-app advertising	Premium barbering brands reaching a captive professional audience	Year 2
Geo PPC	Targeted advertising for shops in high-activity areas	Year 2-3
Education	Accredited academies and educators listed and booked through the platform	Year 2

Progress to Date

- **Platform:** concept fully developed and documented; seven-screen app mockup complete, available on request.
- **Technology:** AI-native architecture designed, MVP specification locked; build targeted at 90 days from funding confirmation.
- **Founding cohort:** Letters of Intent programme under way, targeting 30 founding barbers and 15 founding shops in London, recruited personally by the founder.
- **IP and legal:** barbertemp.ai secured, formal IP protection in progress; platform T&Cs, barber and shop contracts and NDA framework in development.
- **Partnerships:** industry relationships across brands, education and international premium operators mapped, deliberately sequenced post-launch.

The Team

Role	Who	Detail
Managing Director (full time from funding)	Johnny Shanahan	25 years a master barber. Founder of BarberBarberUK, Manchester. Known and trusted across the industry in the UK, US, Australia and Japan. The industry authority behind the platform; recruits the founding cohort personally.
Commercial Lead (advisory)	John Webb O'Rourke	40 years of cross-sector experience in law, finance, property and entrepreneurship. Commercial strategy, investor relationships, legal and governance.
Chief Technical Lead	Shane McCarthy	AI systems architect. Designed the AI-native platform architecture; MVP specification locked. Build delivered by a contracted technical team under his direction.
Operations	COO hire	London-based, full time from Month 2. Onboarding, barber and shop management.

The Raise

	Amount	What it delivers
Minimum raise	£500,000	Covers Year 1 fully (£350,000) with £150,000 runway into Year 2 before revenue or a second raise is required.
Target raise	£600,000 - £750,000	Funds a fuller Year 2, including the Head of Growth hire, without a second raise before London traction is confirmed.

Year 1 is modelled conservatively at £350,000 all-at-risk with zero revenue assumed: legal and IP £25k; MVP build £65k; hosting and infrastructure £12k; MD salary £50k; COO £50k; contracted technical lead £35k; London base £15k; brand and launch £18k; founding member activation £10k; advisory £15k; 15% contingency. First bookings and commission revenue begin Months 5-6 (London founding cohort). Monthly break-even is targeted at Months 20-24. Net capital exposure across the first two years, after revenue, is modelled at £339,000 to £512,000. All figures are planning estimates; the full financial model and two-year investment model are available.

Expansion Roadmap

Phase	Period	Geography	Objective
1 -- Proof of Concept	Months 1-6	London	30 barbers, 15 shops, first 100 bookings. Unit economics confirmed.
2 -- UK Roll-Out	Months 7-18	Manchester, Birmingham, Leeds, Glasgow	Stage 2 raise from London traction. Head of Growth hired.
3 -- Ireland	Months 18-24	Dublin	Second jurisdiction; Enterprise Ireland routes open.
4 -- International	Years 3-4	Australia, US, Japan	Founder's personal network. Series A.

Long-range ambition: on standard marketplace comparables the founding team's planning basis for platform value at Year 5 is in the £100m-£150m range. This is a planning ambition grounded in comparables, not a projection; the near-term investment case rests on London proof of concept and the Stage 2 raise from demonstrated traction.

Why Haatch

BarberTemp is a UK pre-seed, digital-first, two-sided marketplace with revenue from day one of trading, a founder who is the industry's own authority, and a defined 90-day route from funding to live platform. We believe that profile fits the businesses Haatch backs at this stage, and hands-on operator experience is exactly the kind of investor involvement the founding team wants. We would welcome a conversation.

John Webb O'Rourke, Commercial Lead, BarberTemp | barbertemp.ai | Introduced by Graham Byrne | Confidential. Planning estimates throughout; full financial model available on request.